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PRESS RELEASE

DISTRICT DEVELOPMENT COMMISSIONER, DODA LAUNCHES DIGITAL INITIATIVE 'AASHA' TO IDENTIFY & MAINSTREAM OUT-OF-SCHOOL CHILDREN ACROSS THE DISTT. DODA UNDER CSS SCHEME SAMAGRA SHIKSHA

Doda, April 17:

In a landmark move aimed at strengthening educational inclusion and ensuring that every child is brought into the formal education system, the District Administration Doda today launched an innovative digital platform titled **AASHA (https://aasha.ceododa.in)** for district-wide identification, tracking, mainstreaming, and retention of Out-of-School Children (OoSC).

The application was launched at the DC Office Doda by **Sh. Krishan Lal (JKAS), Deputy Commissioner Doda**, in presence of **Sh. Manesh Kr. Manhas (CPO Doda), Sh. Bhushan Kumar Pathak (Chief Education Officer Doda)**, along with other associated Team Members for implementation of the initiative—**AASHA (Action to Assure Schooling and Holistic Access)** .

Developed under the aegis of the Chief Education Office Doda and guided by the District Administration, the initiative serves as a comprehensive web-based mechanism to scientifically identify out-of-school children, generate real-time household-level educational data, facilitate their mainstreaming into schools, and ensure sustained retention through structured monitoring.

The initiative was conceptualized following directions from the Directorate of Samagra Shiksha J&K being headed by **Sh. Bhawani Rakwal (JKAS), Project Director Samagra Shiksha J&K**, regarding fresh surveys and updated OoSC data submission comprising of *Never Enrolled and Dropout Children*. Further

impetus was provided by **Dr. Naseem Javaid Chowdhary (JKAS), Director School Education, Jammu**, who emphasized the adoption of effective field-driven mechanisms for accurate identification. Acting upon these directions, District Doda transitioned from conventional paper-based surveys to a dynamic, technology-driven platform.

The field framework and planning architecture were developed with significant contribution from **Mr. K. D Shah, Auditor, Samagra Shiksha Doda & Mr. Majid Anjum, Programmer Samagra Shiksha Doda** who remained associated with the initiative from its conceptual stage through execution.
A key highlight of the initiative is its **in-house technical development**, led by:

- **Mr. Saqib Ahmed**, In charge IT, Chief Education office, Doda
- **Mr. Rafaqat Rasool**, Vocational Trainer (IT), GHS Nichlathara

Both the developers designed and developed the platform as a **Progressive Web Application (PWA)** using a modern, scalable technology stack. The system emphasizes **intuitive user experience (UX), real-time data capture, offline capability for field surveys, and seamless administrative monitoring dashboards**.
The developers have previously contributed to multiple digital initiatives such as Integrated Management System **(IMS)** and Record Management System **(RMS)** under the close supervision of CEO Doda, details of which are available at **www.ceododa.in**, reflecting a consistent push towards technology-driven governance and innovation in the education sector.

From a compliance and security standpoint, the platform is **MeitY-compliant**, strictly adheres to **data residency norms**, and is built upon a **modern, secure architecture** incorporating safeguards against cyber threats, thereby ensuring data privacy, integrity, and system reliability.

The application is expected to establish a **robust real-time district database** for educational planning and targeted interventions and is viewed as a **technically sound, user-friendly, and field-adaptable solution** to strengthen educational governance.

The district-wide survey under the initiative is scheduled to be completed within the next **10 days** through surveyors identified at the zonal level, who will conduct household visits across all blocks. Orientation of Zonal Nodal Officers has already been completed, who will further train field surveyors for implementation. The survey is expected to commence by 18th of April, with consolidated district data likely to be available by **30 April 2026**.

The initiative aims to:

1. Reduce school dropout rates
2. Improve literacy indicators across District Doda
3. Maximize enrolment in government schools
4. Strengthen retention of enrolled children
5. Ensure access to quality education
6. Optimize resource allocation under Samagra Shiksha

Officials of the core team expressed optimism that the initiative could evolve into a **replicable model for other districts**, given its simplicity, scalability, and digital efficiency. Engagement of NGOs and community stakeholders is also envisaged to support counselling and motivation of identified children and their families.

Speaking on the occasion, **Deputy Commissioner Doda Sh. Krishan Lal (JKAS)** stated that the initiative is appreciable as it reflects the administration's commitment to ensuring universal access to education through **data-driven governance and innovation**. He emphasized that accurate field identification is critical for meaningful educational planning and appreciated the locally developed digital solution. He further directed to

the Chief Education Officer Doda to share the progress on OoSC Survey on daily basis as captured from real-time details on the web application.

Chief Education Officer, Doda Sh. Bhushan Kumar Pathak highlighted that AASHA represents a **practical, technology-enabled step towards universal school access**, ensuring that every identified child is systematically linked to schooling mechanisms and continuously monitored for retention.

Meanwhile the public and parents are requested to extend full cooperation to survey teams during household visits and provide accurate information to ensure the success and integrity of this district-wide initiative.

The initiative stands as a **collective mission of administration, educators, parents, and the community** to ensure that no child is left out of the education system and every child is given the opportunity to learn, grow, and succeed.

Sd/-
Chief Education Officer
Doda